CIRCL
Computer Incident
Response Center
Luxembourg

How to Use the MN MISP Instance

A practical guide for community members — CIRCL 2026

https://www.misp-project.org

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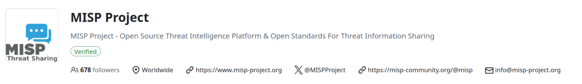
MISP Project https://misp-project.org

What this briefing covers



Three practical questions about the shared **MN MISP instance**:

- **What can I do** on the instance?
- **How do I connect** my own instance to it?
- **Why should I care** about how I connect?

What can I do on the instance?

The MN MISP instance is there to **support your investigations** and to **connect you with the rest of the community**.

Search

- Look up **indicators**
- Query **knowledge-base** items relevant to your incidents

Correlate

- Find **related incidents**
- See who else is affected

Operationalise

- Build **remediation** & **prevention** rules
- Feed data-sets to your tools

Collaborate

- Open **dialogues** with other members
- Ask, support, contribute

Interacting with the community

Every event is an opportunity to **open a dialogue** with the members who produced or are affected by it.

Ask for more

- Request additional information
- Ask for support on an incident

Give back

- Provide improvements or hints
- Correct or enrich existing data

Signal activity

- Simply let the community know that a threat is **still active in the wild**

A single sighting can tell dozens of teams that a threat is not yet over.

How do I connect my instance?

You can interconnect your own MISP with the MN MISP instance in several ways — pick what matches your **operational posture**.

- **Synchronisation** — push and/or pull events between the two instances
  Initiated **by your instance**, or **by NCIA**
- **Cross-correlation only** — cache the remote data to spot overlaps, without ingesting it
- **Filtering** — shape the flow so you only get what is relevant to you

These modes are not exclusive

Most members combine synchronisation with filtering to keep the flow under control.

Two modes of synchronisation

Synchronisation can be driven from either side of the link.

→ You initiate

- Your instance runs the **push / pull**
- You control scheduling and direction
- No inbound access to your instance required

← NCIA initiates

- NCIA pushes to you
- **Real-time** on event publish
- Your instance must be reachable

Mode 1 — Your instance initiates (push / pull)

You reach out to the MN MISP instance and decide when and what to synchronise.

1. Ask NCIA for a **sync user** on the MN MISP instance
2. Add **their instance** as a server on **yours**
3. Decide your posture:

    Ingest only — pull data down, keep quiet, *or*
    Ingest & share back — also push your own contributions

You stay in full control

Scheduling, direction and what leaves your instance are all decided on your side.

Mode 2 — NCIA initiates the synchronisation

You give NCIA a **sync user of your own**, letting them push into your instance.

- Enables **real-time pushes** the moment an event is published by the MN MISP community
- Intel lands in your instance without waiting for your next pull cycle
- Requires your instance to be **reachable** — from the internet or via an uplink

Reachability required

Your instance must be exposed to NCIA — over the internet or a dedicated uplink — for inbound pushes to work.

Cross-correlation only mode

Don't want to ingest the data at all? You can still benefit from it.

- Enable **caching** of the MN MISP instance
- Simply **see what NCIA holds** that may be relevant to you
- Correlations light up **locally**, without copying the full dataset into your own events

Minimal footprint

A lightweight way to know *whether* the community has something on your indicators — before deciding to pull it.

Filtering — staying in control of the flow

Worried about being overwhelmed with data? **Filter** what you take in.

- Constrain the pull by **tags, organisations, distribution**, ...
- You *can* filter out extremely old data — though we **recommend against it**

On filtering out old data

Operational use of 10+ year old events is very low — *but* for threat analysts, watching a threat actor evolve over a decade can be invaluable.

Why should you care?

How you connect matters. Running and synchronising **your own instance** — rather than only querying the shared one — buys you real advantages.

Confidentiality

Your searches can be very sensitive

Availability

Don't depend on shared performance

Capability

Host / admin-only features

Access

Your data — even offline

Confidentiality of your searches

Searches can be **very sensitive**, especially during active incidents.

- The indicators you search for may **accidentally reveal** sensitive information about the infrastructure you protect
- You may want to limit the chance that your **knowledge of an ongoing attack** leaks out during an incident

Every query is a potential signal

During an active incident, keep sensitive lookups on infrastructure *you* control — not on a shared instance.

Performance & availability

On a shared instance, you are **at the mercy of the community** for performance and response times.

- It would be very unfortunate if your tools could **not pull the latest intel** exactly when you need it most ...
- ...simply because the MN MISP instance is **overwhelmed** by an unexpected amount of load from the community
- A local, synchronised copy keeps your tooling **fast and independent**

When it matters most

Peak demand on the shared instance often coincides with the incidents where you can least afford to wait.

The power of your own instance

Beyond confidentiality and availability, hosting your own instance unlocks more.

Extra capability

- Functionality reserved for the **host organisation**
- Administrator-only features

Own the data

- Full access to the data
- Available **even offline**

Key takeaways

- **Capabilities** — search, correlate, operationalise and collaborate on the MN MISP instance
- **Connecting** — synchronise in either direction, cross-correlate via caching, and filter to taste
- **Considerations** — your own instance means confidentiality, availability, extra capability and offline access

Getting started

Request a sync user from NCIA and decide whether you want to *ingest only* or also *share back*.